Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Monday, 2 November 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Overcast	Overcast	Overcast	Overcast
12° 9°	11° 7°	12° 7°	10° 4°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **Former Shadow Chancellor Rachel Reeves says the UK's future should be inside the European Union.**
In her first major intervention since leaving the Treasury, Ms Reeves stated that Brexit has left the UK "poorer, weaker and less secure". It's a significant comment from such a senior Labour figure.
POLITICS · UK

2 **A hospital has admitted full responsibility for the death of a toddler after surgery, due to 24 failures in her care.**
Eleanor Aldred-Owen died following an operation because an abnormal scan was not flagged by staff. The hospital has now taken full responsibility for the tragic mistakes.
HEALTH · UK

3 **Jersey Airport has experienced a second night of drone disruption, affecting inbound flights.**
Authorities reported ongoing drone activity over the weekend, leading to flight cancellations and delays. It's the latest in a series of similar incidents at airports.
TRANSPORT · UK

4 **Seven people have been arrested following city centre firework disorder over the weekend.**
Those arrested are being held on suspicion of various offences, including assault and possession of fireworks. It comes after reports of widespread disruption.
CRIME · UK

5 **British adventurer Karl Bushby is set to complete his incredible 31,000-mile walk around the world today.**
He’s due to arrive in Hull, having walked across continents for decades. He says he's "overwhelmed" by the support as he nears the finish line.
HUMAN INTEREST · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Sir Tom Jones has mentored a Welsh singer to victory on The Voice UK over the weekend!**

Cate McHugh was crowned the winner on Saturday night, with her coach Sir Tom Jones congratulating her on the fantastic achievement. Another Welsh success story!

ON AIR — Are you a fan of The Voice? Who was your favourite this series?

TV · WEEKEND

2 **The actor who played Neil the Baby in Gavin and Stacey is hoping his band will be 'the next Stereophonics'.**

Oscar Hartland, who was Neil in the hit BBC comedy, says he's on a "mission to create a new modern sound for Wales". He's certainly got big ambitions!

ON AIR — What do you think of actors turning to music? Can he be the next big Welsh band?

MUSIC · FUTURE

3 **Plans for a new Brit School North arts college in Bradford have officially been given the go-ahead.**

Inspired by the world-famous Brit School in London, the new college will be built in the centre of Bradford. It's fantastic news for aspiring young performers in the North!

ON AIR — Do you think more specialist arts schools like this are needed across the UK?

EDUCATION · FUTURE

4 **The winners of Celebrity Traitors say they are relieved the secret is finally out after the nail-biting finale!**

The second series of the hit show reached its climax on Friday, attracting a whopping 11.2 million live viewers. The tension was certainly building for the finalists!

ON AIR — Were you watching The Traitors finale? Were you happy with the result?

TV · WEEKEND

5 **The Gruffalo illustrator Axel Scheffler is considering legal action against AI firms over copyright.**

He believes companies are breaching copyright by reproducing his work in AI-generated Gruffalo images. It's a growing concern for artists in the digital age.

ON AIR — Do you think AI should be allowed to use copyrighted images without permission?

ART · FUTURE

Prepflow

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Are Tottenham finally finding some consistency under Roberto de Zerbi after a third successive Premier League win?**

Spurs secured another victory this weekend, leading many to wonder if they've turned a corner. It's certainly a promising sign for the North London club.

ON AIR — Spurs fans, are you feeling more confident about the season ahead?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Brighton secured an impressive 1-0 victory over Manchester City, with pundits praising their 'brave and balanced' performance.**

Match of the Day pundits highlighted Brighton's excellent squad balance in their win against the reigning champions. It was a fantastic result for the Seagulls.

ON AIR — What did you make of Brighton's performance against Man City?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **Wales women suffered a record-breaking defeat in the Rugby League World Cup, thrashed 124-6 by Australia.**

The reigning champions Australia racked up an incredible 21 tries against Wales in Sydney, setting a new international record. A tough day at the office for the Welsh side.

ON AIR — That's a huge scoreline, isn't it? How do teams recover from such a heavy defeat?

RUGBY LEAGUE · INTERNATIONAL

4 **Swedish runner Andreas Almgren has won the New York Marathon on his debut over 26.2 miles.**

Almgren continues his remarkable year with this victory, adding a major marathon title to his achievements. A fantastic debut performance!

ON AIR — Have you ever run a marathon? What's the biggest challenge?

ATHLETICS · INTERNATIONAL

5 **Former Sheffield United legend Billy Sharp has come out of retirement to sign for non-league side AFC Rushden & Diamonds.**

The experienced striker is joining the Northern Premier League side as they prepare for their FA Cup match against Burton Albion. A great boost for the club!

ON AIR — Is it great to see experienced players drop down to help non-league clubs?

FOOTBALL · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **The simple joy of 'a perfectly toasted crumpet' is experiencing a significant renaissance among home bakers and breakfast enthusiasts.**

Many are rediscovering the unique texture and comforting warmth of this traditional British treat, often citing the satisfying crunch and soft interior as key to its appeal. Online communities are now sharing tips for achieving crumpet perfection.

2 **A surprising new trend reveals that people are finding therapeutic calm in the methodical act of 'polishing houseplants'.**

It seems the gentle rhythm and visible results of cleaning leaves not only benefits the plants but also offers a quiet, mindful escape from daily stresses. Special plant-polishing cloths are even becoming a popular gift.

3 **New research suggests that 'the sound of a distant train horn' can evoke a comforting sense of journey and reflection for many.**

Psychologists propose that for some, this sound acts as a subtle reminder of connectivity and adventure, fostering a feeling of gentle anticipation rather than disturbance. It's often associated with nostalgic memories of travel.

4 **The unexpected charm of 'receiving a handwritten note' is being championed as a powerful antidote to digital fatigue.**

In an increasingly online world, the personal touch and effort behind a handwritten message are seen as more meaningful and impactful. People are actively seeking opportunities to send and receive these thoughtful missives.

5 **There's a growing appreciation for the delicate art of 'folding laundry into neat, organised piles' as a form of soothing self-care.**

Many are finding satisfaction in the visual order and tactile experience of transforming a pile of clothes into perfectly stacked items. It's being shared online as a simple way to bring calm to household chores.

6 **Reports indicate a rise in people rediscovering the simple pleasure of 'listening to the radio through static' on an old analogue device.**

The crackle and hiss, once considered a nuisance, is now being embraced by some as a nostalgic backdrop, adding character to the broadcast and a touch of retro charm to their listening experience.

7 **The humble 'rubber duck' is making an unexpected comeback as a symbol of simple joy and nostalgic comfort.**

Beyond the bathtub, these cheerful yellow companions are appearing on desks and shelves, bringing a touch of whimsical positivity to daily routines. Collectors are now seeking out vintage and unique designs.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when trying to decide if a new book in a shop will be a good read, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: GIVING IT A QUICK SNIFF TO CHECK IF IT HAS THAT 'NEW BOOK' SMELL!

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new cup of coffee, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: ADJUSTING ALL THE COASTERS ON THE TABLE TO BE PERFECTLY ALIGNED!

TALK TOPIC

- **We all have those moments, don't we, when you're just about to leave the house, and you realise you've forgotten something utterly essential, even though you just checked?**
  What's the one thing you absolutely cannot leave the house without, and what's the silliest thing you've ever completely forgotten, forcing you to turn back?

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday sound' just instantly makes you feel calm, or happy, or even a bit nostalgic, even if it's not a particularly musical sound?**
  What's a surprisingly soothing or evocative everyday sound for you, and why does it have that effect? Maybe it's the gentle hum of the fridge, or the distant rumble of a delivery lorry!

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of owls is actually called a 'parliament'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** It's said that if you gently whisper 'good morning' to a houseplant every day, it will grow twice as fast.

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth, visible from outer space.
- A bolt of lightning is five times hotter than the surface of the sun.
- The dot over the lowercase 'i' and 'j' is called a tittle.
- There are more stars in the universe than grains of sand on all the beaches on Earth.
- The world's quietest room is at Microsoft's headquarters in Washington state; it's so quiet you can hear your own heartbeat.
- The 'sixth' sick sheik's sixth sheep's sick' is considered the toughest tongue twister in the English language.
- Bananas are berries, but strawberries are not.
- The highest temperature ever recorded on Earth was 56.7 degrees Celsius (134 Fahrenheit) in Death Valley, USA.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES MON 2 NOV 2026

On this day

Day 306 of the year, 59 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Agapius and companions; Christian feast day: Domninus of Vienne; Christian feast day: Erc of Slane (Ireland); Christian feast day: Justus of Trieste. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Topaz.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1921 — Shepard Menken, American actor (died 1999)
- 1975 — Chris Walla, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, and producer
- 1962 — Derek Mountfield, English footballer and manager
- 1959 — Peter Mullan, Scottish actor, director, and screenwriter
- 1947 — Kate Linder, American actress
- 1974 — Nelly, American rapper
- 1974 — Prodigy, American rapper (died 2017)
- 1928 — James Luisi, American basketball player and actor (died 2002)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1965 — Norman Morrison, a 31-year-old Quaker, sets himself on fire in front of the river entrance to the Pentagon to protest the use of napalm in the Vietnam war.
- 1956 — Suez Crisis: Israel occupies the Gaza Strip.
- 1988 — LOT Polish Airlines Flight 703 crashes in Białobrzegi, Podkarpackie Voivodeship, Poland, killing one person and injuring several more.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1959 — Quiz show scandals: Twenty-One game show contestant Charles Van Doren admits to a Congressional committee that he had been given questions and answers in advance.
- 1997 — Tropical Storm Linda makes landfall in the Mekong Delta in Vietnam, causing more than 3,000 deaths.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2000 — Expedition 1 arrived at the International Space Station for the first long-duration stay onboard. From this day to present, a continuous human presence in space on the station remains uninterrupted.
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1960 — Penguin Books is found not guilty of obscenity in the trial R v Penguin Books Ltd, the Lady Chatterley's Lover case.

- 1986 — Lebanon hostage crisis: U.S. hostage David Jacobsen is released in Beirut after 17 months in captivity.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES TUE 3 NOV 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 307 of the year, 58 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Acepsimas of Hnaita and companions (Greek Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Alpaïs of Cudot; Christian feast day: Elias I of Antioch (Syriac Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Ermengol (Hermengaudius). Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Topaz.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1973 — Mick Thomson, American guitarist
- 1956 — Kevin Murphy, American actor, puppeteer, producer, and screenwriter
- 1963 — Ian Wright, English footballer, manager, and sportscaster
- 1924 — Marc Breaux, American actor, director, and choreographer (died 2013)
- 1957 — Gary Olsen, English actor (died 2000)
- 1953 — Helios Creed, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1949 — Mike Evans, American actor and screenwriter (died 2006)
- 1973 — Ben Fogle, English television host and author

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1994 — Space Shuttle program: Atlantis launches on STS-66.
- 1979 — Greensboro massacre: Five members of the Communist Workers Party are shot dead and seven are wounded by a group of Klansmen and neo-Nazis during a "Death to the Klan" rally in Greensboro, North Carolina, United States.
- 1992 — Democratic Arkansas Governor Bill Clinton defeats Republican President George H. W. Bush and Independent candidate Ross Perot in the 1992 United States presidential election.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1973 — Mariner program: NASA launches the Mariner 10 toward Mercury. On March 29, 1974, it becomes the first space probe to reach that planet.
- 1976 — Carrie, an American supernatural horror film directed by Brian De Palma, is premiered in 17 theaters in the Washington, D.C.-Baltimore area.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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